AI-FIRST ENTERPRISE TRANSFORMATION | CONSULTING ENGAGEMENT

Current-State Assessment & AI Maturity

Where the enterprise stands, and what actually blocks it

Contents of this deliverable

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Deliverable 01 | July 2026 | Draft for discussion

Illustrative engagement package. Assumptions stated in Deliverable 00 apply throughout.

1. Assessment Approach

In a live engagement this assessment draws on 40-60 stakeholder interviews, architecture and data-estate reviews, spend analysis, a skills inventory, and a scan of in-flight AI initiatives. The reference findings below reflect the modal pattern we observe in enterprises of this profile; each cell should be validated in a 4-6 week discovery sprint, which is the first roadmap activity.

2. Thirteen-Dimension Enterprise Assessment

Dimension	Current-state finding (reference)	Rating
Business model	Value creation still assumes human-throughput economics; pricing and cost models not yet stress-tested against AI-native entrants	Amber
Industry dynamics	AI adoption accelerating across the sector; 12-24 month window before capability gaps become visible in margins and NPS	Amber
Competitive landscape	Peers announcing AI programs; differentiation still available in proprietary-data domains; AI-native startups attacking narrow slices	Amber
Digital maturity	Customer channels partially digitized; core transactions modernized unevenly; batch integration prevalent	Amber
AI maturity	Level 2 of 5 (Experimenting) - pilots without platform, governance, or benefits tracking	Red
Technology landscape	Hybrid estate; 30-40% of app portfolio legacy; API coverage partial; duplicate capabilities across units	Amber
Data maturity	Fragmented ownership; inconsistent quality; no semantic layer; unstructured knowledge (documents, tickets, calls) largely dark	Red
Organizational structure	Functional silos; AI accountability diffuse across IT, digital, and analytics; no single leader owns outcomes	Red
Engineering maturity	CI/CD adopted in pockets; platform engineering nascent; MLOps/LLMOps absent; evaluation ad hoc	Amber
Security posture	Solid perimeter and endpoint controls; no controls designed for non-human agent identity, prompt injection, or model abuse	Amber
Regulatory constraints	Privacy regimes (GDPR/CCPA-class) apply; EU AI Act obligations phasing in for deployers; sector rules on automated decisions	Amber
Vendor ecosystem	Multiple overlapping AI vendor pilots; no evaluation framework; contract terms silent on data use for training and IP indemnity	Red
Culture & change readiness	High curiosity, high anxiety; middle management unequipped to redesign work; prior transformation fatigue	Amber

Rating scale: Green = strength to build on; Amber = gap that constrains scale; Red = blocking issue requiring Horizon 1 remediation.

3. AI Maturity Assessment

Level	Description	Markers
1. Aware	Leadership discusses AI; no structured activity	Slideware, vendor demos
2. Experimenting **(current)**	Disconnected pilots; individual productivity tools; no platform or governance	25-40 uncoordinated initiatives; shadow AI; no audited benefits
3. Operationalizing **(target month 12)**	Shared platform; governance live; first use cases in production with measured value	Lighthouses in production; risk tiering enforced; FinOps for tokens
4. Scaling **(target month 24)**	Portfolio managed as products; agentic workflows in bounded domains; data flywheel turning	Double-digit production use cases; agent registry; benefits in P&L;
5. AI-Native **(target month 36)**	AI-first process design is default; autonomous operations in selected domains; AI embedded in products	Human-plus-agent workforce norm; continuous evaluation culture

The distance from Level 2 to Level 4 is primarily organizational, not technical: the same 18-month journey fails in enterprises that treat it as an IT program and succeeds where a business-accountable leader owns it.

4. Business Capability Heat Map

Capabilities are scored on two axes: **AI leverage potential** (how much AI could improve the capability) and **current readiness** (data, process stability, and talent to absorb it). The gap between the two defines the transformation agenda.

Business capability	AI leverage potential	Current readiness	Heat
Customer service & support	Very high	Medium (interaction data exists, fragmented KB)	HOT - lighthouse candidate
Software engineering	Very high	High (code is well-structured data; tooling mature)	HOT - lighthouse candidate
Sales & pipeline management	High	Medium (CRM hygiene issues)	HOT
Marketing & content	High	Medium-high	HOT
Finance (close, FP&A;, AP/AR)	High	Medium (structured data strong, process variation high)	WARM
Knowledge management	Very high	Low (dark unstructured data)	WARM - foundational, fix in H1
Supply chain & operations	High	Low-medium (sensor/ERP data gaps)	WARM
HR & talent	Medium-high	Medium; elevated regulatory sensitivity (automated employment decisions)	WARM - govern first
Legal & compliance	Medium-high	Medium; privilege and confidentiality constraints	WARM
Procurement	Medium-high	Medium	WARM
IT operations & cybersecurity	High	Medium-high (rich telemetry)	HOT
Risk & compliance monitoring	High	Medium	WARM

Business capability	AI leverage potential	Current readiness	Heat
Executive decision support	High	Low (no semantic layer; metric definitions inconsistent)	COOL until data layer exists

5. Hidden Bottlenecks and Organizational Debt

Systemic constraints that will silently cap the program

- **Metric anarchy.** Core business terms (customer, churn, margin) defined differently across units. Any AI system built on inconsistent semantics automates the inconsistency. Remediation: semantic layer as a Horizon 1 deliverable.
- **Project-based funding.** Annual capex cycles kill iterative AI products, which need continuous funding against outcome metrics. Remediation: product-based funding for the AI portfolio (Deliverable 05).
- **Middle-management incentive gap.** Managers are measured on throughput of current processes, not on redesigning them. AI adoption stalls exactly at this layer. Remediation: redesign incentives and give managers first access to tools.
- **Risk processes built for deterministic software.** Change advisory boards and testing regimes assume reproducible outputs. Probabilistic systems need evaluation-based assurance instead. Remediation: risk-tiered AI assurance (Deliverable 04).
- **Expertise walking out the door.** Institutional knowledge lives in the heads of a retiring cohort and in unsearchable documents. Every year of delay in knowledge capture is unrecoverable. Remediation: knowledge engineering program (Deliverable 03).
- **Vendor lock-in by inattention.** Pilots are quietly hard-coding single-vendor dependencies without exit provisions. Remediation: model-agnostic gateway and contract standards (Deliverables 03 and 04).